

# Voice Restructuring in Korean Psych Adjectives

## NOM-ACC Case Alternation Without Long Object Movement

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## 1.1. Case Alternation in Korean Psych Adjectives

- (1) a. Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-ko **siph-ta**.  
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-KO **want-DECL**  
*'I want to eat an apple.'*
- b. Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-ki **silh/mwusep-ta**.  
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-KI **dislike/be.afraid.of-DECL**  
*'I hate to eat/am afraid of eating an apple.'*
- (2) Na-nun **sakwa-(ka\*)/-lul** **mek-nun-ta**.  
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** **eat-PRS-DECL**.  
*'I eat an apple.'*
- A subset of Korean psych adjectives exhibit NOM-ACC case alternation when they select embedded predicates.
  - The object can optionally take nominative case (1), which is not possible in an unembedded environment (2).

## 1.2. Agent-Oriented Adverb Modification

### Compatibility with agent-oriented adverbs

- (3) a. Na-nun **sonswu/ilpwule**                      cip(-i\*)/-ul                      cis-ko                      siph-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP    **with.own.hands/on.purpose**    house-NOM/-ACC    build-KO    want-PST-DECL  
*Intended: 'I wanted to build a house with my own hands/on purpose.'*
- b. Na-nun **sonswu/ilpwule**                      cip(-i\*)/-ul                      cis-ki                      silh-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP    **with.own.hands/on.purpose**    house-NOM/-ACC    build-KI    dislike-PST-DECL  
*Intended: 'I hated to build a house with my own hands/on purpose.'*

- Agent-oriented adverbs like **sonswu** 'with one's own hands' or **ilpwule** 'on purpose' are restricted to the Accusative Object Construction only.

## 1.3 Time Modification and Embedded Progressive Aspect

### Compatibility with time adverbs

- (4) Na-nun **phyenci(?-ka)/-lul** **nayil** ssu-ko siph-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP **letter-NOM/-ACC** **tomorrow** write-KO want-PST-DECL

*'I wanted to write a letter tomorrow.'*

*Intended: The adverb tomorrow modifies the writing event, independently of wanting.*

### Progressive aspect marker -ko iss

- (5) a. Na-nun **chayk(-i\*)/-ul** ilk-**ko iss**-ko siph-ta.  
 I-TOP **book-NOM/-ACC** read-**PROG**-KO want-DECL

*'I want to be reading a book'*

- b. \*Na-nun **chayk(-i\*)/-ul** ilk-**ko iss**-ki silh-ta.  
 I-TOP **book-NOM/-ACC** read-**PROG**-KI dislike-DECL

*'I do not want to be reading a book.'*

## 1.4. Duration Modification and Non-Finiteness

### Event duration modification

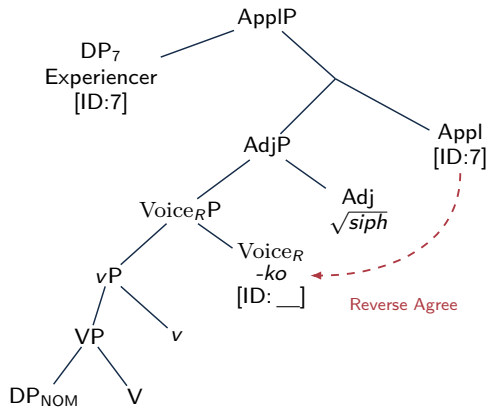
- (6) Na-nun **cam-i/-ul** **sip** **pwun** **tongan** ca-ko siph-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP **sleep-NOM/-ACC** **ten** **minute** **for** sleep-KO want-PST-DECL  
*'I wanted to sleep for ten minutes.'*

### Embedded finite tense marking

- (7) a. Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-ko siph-**ess**-ta.  
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-KO want-**PST**-DECL  
*'I wanted to eat an apple.'*
- b. \*Na-nun **sakwa-ka/-lul** mek-**ess**-ko siph-ta.  
 I-TOP **apple-NOM/-ACC** eat-**PST**-KO want-DECL  
*Intended: 'I want to have eaten an apple.'*

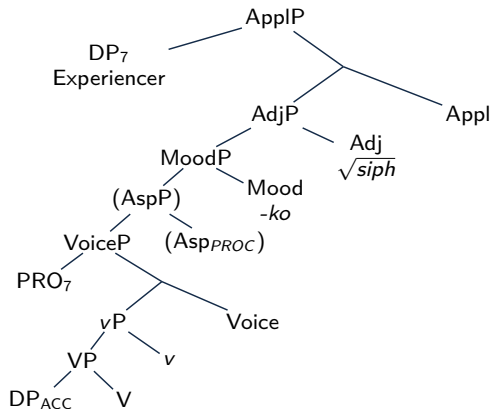
## 2.1. Complement Size Difference Under a Lexical Adjective

### Voice Restructuring (NOM-marked object)



- (8) Na-nun **sakwa-ka** mek-ko siph-ta.  
I-TOP **apple-NOM** eat-KO want-DECL  
'I want to eat an apple.'

### Non-Restructuring (ACC-marked object)



- (9) Na-nun **sakwa-lul** mek-ko siph-ta.  
I-TOP **apple-ACC** eat-KO want-DECL  
'I want to eat an apple.'

## 2.2. Voice Restructuring and Reverse Agree

### Voice restructuring (Wurmbrand 2014, Wurmbrand & Shimamura 2017)

- The embedded  $\text{Voice}_R\text{P}$  contains deficient  $\text{Voice}_R$  and no projected external argument PRO.
- From the start of the derivation, Appl has the experiencer's valued [ID] feature, whereas  $\text{Voice}_R$  bears an unvalued [ID: \_\_] feature.

### Reverse Agree (Bryant, Kovač & Wurmbrand 2023)

- **Reverse Agree:** A higher element supplies an ID value to an accessible, c-commanded lower head.

$$\underbrace{\text{DP}_7[\text{ID} : 7]}_{\text{experiencer}} \quad \& \quad \text{Appl}[\text{ID} : 7] \longrightarrow \text{Voice}_R[\text{ID} : \_ \mapsto 7]$$

- In the NOC, the shared index identifies the embedded understood agent with the matrix experiencer, without the help of PRO.

## 2.3. Dependent Case Theory and the NOM–ACC alternation

### NOM as a Default case & ACC as a Dependent case

- **CP and VoiceP are case domains.**
- Within a case domain, an eligible nominal receives dependent ACC when another case competitor c-commands it.

### Nominative Object Construction (Voice Restructuring)

$$[Voice_R P \ [_{\nu P} DP_{NOM} V] \ Voice_R]$$

- With **no PRO**, there is no local case competition and **no dependent ACC**.

### Accusative Object Construction (Non-Restructuring)

$$[Voice_P \ PRO_i \ [_{\nu P} DP_{ACC} V] \ Voice]$$

- **PRO** c-commands the object within the same VoiceP case domain, allowing the object **to receive ACC**.



### 3.1. Adjectival Adnominal Morphology

- (10) a. **coh-un** / \*coh-nun                      chayk  
           **good-ADN** / good-ADN.PRS.V    book  
           *'a good book'*
- b. \*ilk-un / **ilk-nun**                      chayk  
           read-ADN / **read-ADN.PRS.V**    book  
           *'a book that (someone) is reading'*
- (11) a. ilk-ko        **siph-un** / \*siph-nun                      chayk  
           read-KO    **want-ADN** / want-ADN.PRS.V    book  
           *'a book that (I) want to read'*
- b. ilk-ki        **silh-un** / \*silh-nun                      chayk  
           read-KI    **dislike-ADN** / dislike-ADN.PRS.V    book  
           *'a book that (I) do not want to read'*

- In Korean, verbs and adjectives take different adnominal markers (10).
- In a present-state reading, restructuring psych adjectives take the adjectival marker *-un* (11).  
 The embedded verb *ilk* 'to read' does not determine the choice of adnominal marker.

## 3.2. Sentence-final Tense and Aspect

- (12) a. Na-nun chayk-ul ilk-ko **siph-~~Ø~~-ta** / \*siph-nun-ta.  
 I-TOP book-ACC read-KO **want-PRS.Adj-DECL** / want-PRS.V-DECL  
*'I want to read a book.'*
- b. Na-nun chayk-ul ilk-ki **silh-~~Ø~~-ta** / \*silh-nun-ta.  
 I-TOP book-ACC read-KI **dislike-PRS.Adj-DECL** / dislike-PRS.V-DECL  
*'I do not want to read a book.'*

| Class                         | -nun (PRS) | -ess/-ass (PST) | -ko iss- (PROG) |
|-------------------------------|------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Verb                          | ✓          | ✓               | ✓               |
| Adjective                     | *          | ✓               | *               |
| Restructuring psych adjective | *          | ✓               | *               |

### 3.3. -e ha Verbalization and Lexical Status

(13) a. Na-nun **sulph**-ta.  
I-TOP **sad**-DECL  
*'I am sad.'*

b. Na-nun **sulph-e ha**-n-ta.  
I-TOP **sad-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL  
*'I feel sad.'*

(14) a. Mina-nun chayk-ul ilk-ko **siph-e ha**-n-ta.  
Mina-TOP book-ACC read-KO **want-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL  
*'Mina wants to read a book.'*

b. \*Mina-nun koylop-e **ya ha-e ha**-n-ta.  
Mina-TOP be.in.distress-**MOD-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL  
*Intended: 'Mina has to feel distressed.'*

c. \*Mina-nun oylop-e **to toy-e ha**-n-ta.  
Mina-TOP lonely-**MOD-VBLZ**-PRS-DECL  
*Intended: 'Mina is allowed to feel lonely.'*

- Like lexical psych adjectives (13), restructuring psych adjectives allow -e ha verbalization (14a), supporting their **lexical status**.
- Periphrastic modals block this verbalization when they intervene (14b–c).

### 3.4. Variation in Morphological Integration

#### Adverb insertion

- (15) a. \*Na-nun pap-i mek-ko **cengmal** siph-ta.  
I-TOP meal-NOM eat-KO **really** want-DECL  
*Intended: 'I really want to eat a meal.'*
- b. Na-nun pap-i mek-ki **cengmal** silh-ta.  
I-TOP meal-NOM eat-KI **really** dislike-DECL  
*'I really do not want to eat a meal.'*

#### Case marking on the complement

- (16) a. \*Na-nun cip-ey ka-ko-ka siph-ta.  
I-TOP home-LOC go-KO-NOM want-DECL  
*Intended: 'I want to go home.'*
- b. Na-nun cip-ey ka-ki-ka silh-ta.  
I-TOP home-LOC go-KI-NOM dislike-DECL  
*'I do not want to go home.'*

## 3.5. Variation in Selectional Property

### Availability of a *-kes* clause

- (17) a. \*Na-nun [Mina-ka ttena-n **kes-i**] **siph**-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP Mina-NOM leave-ADN **KES**-NOM **want**-PST-DECL  
*Intended: 'I wanted Mina to have left.'*
- b. Na-nun [Mina-ka ttena-n **kes-i**] **silh**-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP Mina-NOM leave-ADN **KES**-NOM **dislike**-PST-DECL  
*'I disliked the fact that Mina had left.'*

### Availability of a nominal object

- (18) a. \*Na-nun **Mina-ka** **siph**-ta.  
 I-TOP **Mina-NOM** want-DECL  
*Intended: 'I want Mina.'*
- b. Na-nun **Mina-ka** **silh**-ta.  
 I-TOP **Mina-NOM** dislike-DECL  
*'I dislike Mina.'*

- But **the restructuring effects cut across this class-internal variation** in lexical integrity
- The suffixal status of *-siph* 'to want' is largely irrelevant to the restructuring pattern.

## 4.1. Lack of Subject Experiencer Verb Effect

- (19) a. I hate dogs. Generic; #nonspecific existential  
 b. I hate some dogs. Specific individuals or specific subkinds

- (20) a. \*?Na-nun **salam-i** **han-myeng** mwusep-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP **person-NOM** **one-CL** be.afraid.of-PST-DECL

*Intended: 'I feared one person.'*

Case-medial order: nonspecific reading required, which is unacceptable here.

- b. Na-nun **salam** **han-myeng-i** mwusep-ess-ta.  
 I-TOP **person** **one-CL-NOM** be.afraid.of-PST-DECL

*'I feared a certain person.'*

Case-final order: specific reading only with the psych adjective *mwusep* 'to be afraid'.

- As Seres and Espinal (2018) point out, **subject experiencer verbs cross-linguistically restrict existential readings of their objects** (19).
- Korean simplex psych adjectives show a parallel restriction. **Case-medial order** permits only an existential reading, which **is incompatible with this context** (20a). **Case-final order** normally permits both readings, but *mwusep* 'to be afraid' **rules out the existential reading** in (20b).

## 4.1. Lack of Subject Experiencer Verb Effect

- (21) a. Na-nun **salam-ul/-i** **han-myeng** manna-ko **siph-ess-ta**.  
 I-TOP **person-ACC/-NOM** **one-CL** meet-KO **want-PST-DECL**  
*'I wanted to meet one person, not any particular person.'*  
 Case-medial order: nonspecific existential reading with both ACC and NOM.

- b. Na-nun **salam** **han-myeng-ul/-i** manna-ko **siph-ess-ta**.  
 I-TOP **person** **one-CL-ACC/-NOM** meet-KO **want-PST-DECL**  
*'I wanted to meet one person.'*  
 Case-final order: specific or nonspecific existential reading with either case.

- The embedded object of psych adjective constructions escapes this restriction (21).
- This evidence argues against an analysis in which restructuring psych adjectives directly select the embedded object.

## 4.2. Person Restriction On the Experiencer Subject

- (22) a. **Na-nun** / **#Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ko **siph-ta**.  
**I-TOP** / **Mina-TOP** meal-ACC eat-KO **want-DECL**  
*'I want to eat a meal.'* / *#'Mina wants to eat a meal.'*
- b. **Na-nun** / **#Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ki **silh-ta**.  
**I-TOP** / **Mina-TOP** meal-ACC eat-KI **dislike-DECL**  
*'I do not want to eat.'* / *#'Mina does not want to eat.'*

C.-M. Lee (2013)

- (23) a. **Ne-nun** / **#Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ko **siph-ni?**  
**you-TOP** / **Mina-TOP** meal-ACC eat-KO **want-Q**  
*'Do you want to eat?'* / *#'Does Mina want to eat?'*
- b. **Mina-nun** pap-ul mek-ko **siph-tay**.  
**Mina-TOP** meal-ACC eat-KO **want-REP**  
*'Mina reportedly wants to eat.'*

- Restructuring psych adjectives *siph* and *silh* show a **person restriction** on the **experiencer subject** (22–23).
- This person restriction on the subject argument supports **control** over raising analysis.



## 5.1. Anti-Reconstruction Effect in NOC

- (24) a. Na-nun **sakwa-man-ul** mek-ko **siph-ta**.  
 I-TOP **apple-ONLY-ACC** eat-KO **want-DECL**  
*'I want to eat only apples.'*

✓ WANT > ONLY      ✓ ONLY > WANT

- b. Na-nun **sakwa-man-i** mek-ko **siph-ta**.  
 I-TOP **apple-ONLY-NOM** eat-KO **want-DECL**  
*'Apples are the only things I want to eat.'*

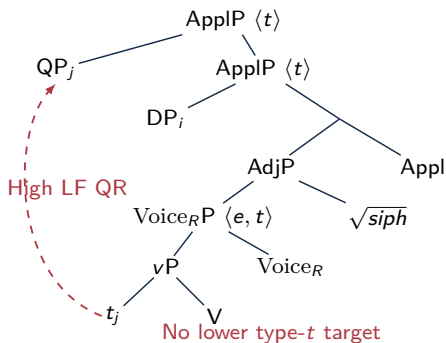
\*WANT > ONLY      ✓ ONLY > WANT

Lee (2023: 72–75), (78)–(82)

- One possible objection concerns the **anti-reconstruction effect** in the NOC (24b). The nominative object allows only a high scope reading unlike non-restructuring AOC (24a).
- **Possible solution:** case is licensed in situ while **QR at LF** can require high scope if no lower interpretation site is available.

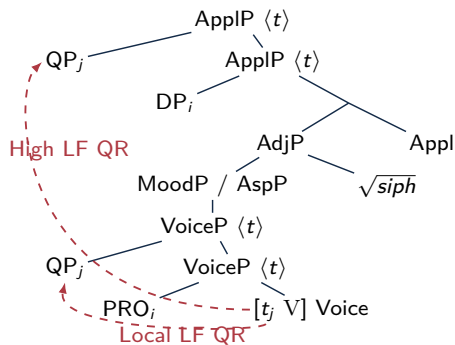
## 5.2. Voice Structure Shapes Case and Scope Facts

### NOC (Restructuring)



No embedded subject. The lower predicate remains of type  $\langle e, t \rangle$ . QR must reach the matrix proposition, above the adjectival predicate *siph* 'want'

### AOC (Non-Restructuring)



With PRO, the lower  $\text{VoiceP}$  denotes a proposition of type  $\langle t \rangle$ . Local QR gives low scope, while QR to the matrix proposition gives high scope.

## 5.3. Restructuring diagnostics in Korean

| Diagnostic               | Korean and its implication                                                          |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Clitic climbing          | No comparable Romance-type object-clitic climbing diagnostic.                       |
| Cross-clausal scrambling | Can cross a full finite CP, and therefore not restricted to a deficient complement. |

Typological framing follows Wurmbrand (2014)

- (25) **Chayk-ul<sub>j</sub>** na-nun [**CP** Mina-ka *t<sub>j</sub>* ilk-ess-ta-ko] **sayngkakha-n-ta.**  
**book-ACC** I-TOP [**Mina-NOM** read-PST-DECL-C] **think-PRS-DECL**  
*'This book, I think that Mina read.'*

- A subject, past tense, and overt C show a **full CP status** (25). Extraction across it does not diagnose typical restructuring phenomena.
- The most plausible typological approach is to use case patterns and other evidence to identify a reduced Voice domain, a precondition for Voice restructuring phenomena.

## 5.4. Voice restructuring without long object movement

### Japanese Long Passive

- (26) **Hanbaagaa-ga** kodomo-ni atae-tsuzuke-**rare**-ta.  
**hamburger-NOM** child-DAT give-continue-**PASS**-PST  
*'Hamburgers continued to be given to children.'*

Shimamura & Wurmbrand (2014)

### Long passive not attested in Korean

- (27) a. Chelswu-ka **ku chayk-ul** ilk-ki sicak-**ha**-yess-ta.  
 Chelswu-NOM **that book-ACC** read-KI begin-**ACT**-PST-DECL  
*'Chelswu began to read that book.'*
- b. \***Ku chayk-i** ilk-ki sicak-**toy**-ess-ta.  
**that book-NOM** read-KI begin-**PASS**-PST-DECL  
*Intended long passive: 'That book was begun to be read.'*

- However, the absence of long object movement does not necessarily rule out a Voice Restructuring analysis, since Voice<sub>R</sub> can be unavailable in the verbal domain for independent reasons in Korean.

## 5.5. Desiderative *-tai* in Japanese, a possible connection?

- (28) a. Watasi-wa hon-ga/-o **yomi-tai.**  
I-TOP book-NOM/-ACC **read-DES-ADJ.NPST**  
*'I want to read a book.'*
- b. Hon-ga **yomi-tsuzuke-rare-ta.**  
book-NOM **read-continue-PASS-PST**  
*'The book continued to be read.'*

Constructed pair; Ohtani & Steedman (2008: 290) and Shimamura & Wurmbrand (2014).

- Restructuring effects similar to those of Korean psych adjectives are observed in the Japanese *-tai* desiderative construction in case alternation (28a), scope interpretation (Kubota 2007) and adverbial modification (Ohtani & Steedman 2008).
- The same conjunctive form appears in both the *-tai* construction (28a) and the long passive construction (28b). Long passivization requires high scope of *dake* 'only' (Fukuda 2012), paralleling the scope behavior of NOC *-tai*, though their relation remains to be investigated.

## 6. Conclusion

- 1 **Complement size** The NOC contains deficient  $\text{Voice}_R$  without PRO. The AOC contains a full VoiceP with PRO, as well as MoodP and optionally AspP above it.
- 2 **Adjectival control** Psych adjectives such as *siph* 'want' and *silh* 'dislike' select a matrix subject experiencer. In the NOC, Reverse Agree identifies this experiencer with the understood embedded agent, leading to a typical Voice restructuring effect.
- 3 **Case and scope** Without a local case competitor, the NOC object receives default NOM. In the AOC, PRO serves as a local competitor, and the object receives dependent ACC. The type mismatch arising from this difference also explains the otherwise puzzling scope facts.
- 4 **Typological generalization.** Japanese exhibits NOM–ACC alternation with psych adjectives and long passives in the verbal domain, while Korean lacks the latter. Future work should explain this contrast within a typology of Voice restructuring.

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